Affirmative Asylum Interview (General Process)

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Disclaimer: Educational information only, not legal advice. We are not a law firm and are not affiliated with USCIS, the U.S. Department of State or any government agency. Immigration law changes often; always check the official source and consider speaking with a licensed immigration attorney or a DOJ-accredited representative.

This page explains the general affirmative asylum interview process. Asylum cases are complex and deeply personal; we strongly recommend legal help. We do not provide practice answers for asylum claims.

Key facts from official sources

- In the affirmative process, a person physically present in the U.S. files Form I-589 with USCIS and is interviewed by an asylum officer. [Source 2]
- Applicants generally must file Form I-589 within 1 year of their last arrival in the U.S., unless they qualify for an exception. [Source 2]
- If you are not fluent in English, follow the interpreter instructions on your interview notice. [Source 2]

Commonly reported practice questions

Commonly reported practice questions: these are general topics people report being asked about. They are NOT an official USCIS or Department of State list. Officers may ask anything related to your case. Answer truthfully and consistently with your forms.

- Questions confirming your identity, background and the information on your Form I-589.
- Questions asking you to explain in your own words why you left and why you fear returning.
- Questions about your travel to and entry into the United States.

Document checklist

Always follow the list on your own interview notice or embassy instructions first.

☐ Interview notice

☐ Passport and identity documents you have

☐ Copy of your Form I-589 and all evidence filed

☐ Originals of documents you submitted, with certified translations

☐ Interpreter, if your notice says you must bring one

Interview day tips

- Tell the truth; consistency with your application matters.
- It is okay to say you do not remember or do not know.
- Seek help from a licensed attorney or DOJ-accredited representative; many nonprofits offer free or low-cost help.

Stay organized

Keep your documents and deadlines in one place with PathwayUS, an organizing tool (not legal help): mypathwayusa.com/landing

Sources

1 USCIS: Asylum: https://www.uscis.gov/humanitarian/refugees-and-asylum/asylum

2 USCIS: The Affirmative Asylum Process: https://www.uscis.gov/humanitarian/refugees-and-asylum/asylum/the-affirmative-asylum-process

3 USCIS: Find Legal Services: https://www.uscis.gov/scams-fraud-and-misconduct/avoid-scams/find-legal-services

Contact: pnsglobalIlc@gmail.com · Sources checked 2026-10-16. Practice questions are general and not official.